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Comprehensive overview of ecocriticism.

Definition: Ecocriticism is an interdisciplinary study of literature and the environment, combining insights from sciences, humanities, and social sciences to analyze environmental issues and explore solutions.

Key milestones:

1. The Ecocriticism Reader (1996) edited by Cheryl Glotfelty and Harold From
2. The Environmental Imagination (1995) by Lawrence Buell

Focus areas:

1. Human-nature relationships in literature
2. Environmental issues and cultural representations
3. Attitudes towards nature and ecological aspects
4. Individual and societal behavior towards the environment

Goals:

1. Analyze environmental issues in literature
2. Examine cultural attitudes towards nature
3. Study human behavior and ecological interactions
4. Explore solutions for environmental problems

Characteristics:

1. Interdisciplinary approach
2. Broad scope (encompassing green studies, ecopoetics, environmental literary criticism)
3. Focus on contemporary environmental concerns

4. Emphasis on technological impacts

Significance:

1. Brings new dimensions to literary and theoretical studies
2. Addresses pressing environmental issues
3. Encourages critical thinking and sustainability

Other designations:

1. Green (cultural) studies
2. Ecopoetics
3. Environmental literary criticism

Influential scholars:

1. Cheryl Glotfelty
2. Harold From
3. Lawrence Buell
4. William Howarth
5. Greta Gaard

Key texts:

1. The Ecocriticism Reader
2. The Environmental Imagination
3. Ecocriticism: A Critical Introduction (2010) by Timothy Morton

Applications:

1. Literary analysis
2. Environmental studies
3. Cultural studies
4. Sustainability studies
5. Ecological philosophy

Historically, Western thought has viewed nature as a resource to serve human needs, adopting a utilitarian attitude. However, since the 18th century, a growing chorus of voices has challenged this anthropocentric view, advocating for a reevaluation of the human-environment relationship.

Deep Ecology: A Holistic Approach

Arne Naess's concept of Deep Ecology emphasizes the intrinsic interconnectedness of all life forms and natural features, promoting a symbiotic and holistic worldview. This perspective recognizes the inherent value of non-human entities and challenges the dominant human-centered approach.

Expanding Critical Analysis: From Social Justice to Ecological Concerns*

Initially, literary and cultural studies focused on issues like class, race, gender, and region. However, in response to the looming ecological crisis, scholars have begun to incorporate environmental concerns into their critical frameworks.

The Urgent Need for Environmental Action

The late 20th century has brought to the forefront pressing environmental issues, including:

1. Nuclear war
2. Resource depletion
3. Population explosion
4. Exploitative technologies

Ecocriticism and Green Movements

In response, literary and cultural theory has integrated ecological concerns into academic discourse. Concurrently, global green movements have emerged, with some gaining governmental representation.

Key Features of Ecocritical Thought:

1. Interconnectedness of human and non-human entities
2. Challenge to anthropocentrism
3. Emphasis on sustainability and environmental justice
4. Recognition of the intrinsic value of nature

Influential Figures:

1. Arne Naess (Deep Ecology)
2. Rachel Carson (Environmentalism)
3. Aldo Leopold (Ecological Thinking)
4. Timothy Morton (Ecocriticism)

Critical Frameworks:

1. Ecocriticism
2. Environmental Literary Criticism
3. Green Cultural Studies